RSS Digest
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1. Introducing Our Smallest, Most Efficient Model: Muse Ember
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-11-10T07:28:21+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Nov/10/muse-ember/
Introducing Our Smallest, Most Efficient Model: Muse Ember Meta AI just launched their entry in the Claude Haiku/GPT Luna category: Muse Ember, which they describe as: [...] our smallest and most efficient model designed for complex reasoning execution and the work agents repeat all day: tool calls, coding subtasks, routing, extraction, and long document parsing. For shorter prompts it’s priced the same as GPT-6 Luna and Claude Haiku 5.5 - both are $0.10/million input tokens and $0.50/million output. Today’s other big model release, Claude Fable 5.2, is 80x that price at $8/$40. The pricing is a little less straightforward as prompts get longer, though. Luna, Ember, and Haiku all support up to a million input tokens, but they also all have a threshold after which the price goes up. Taking that threshold into account Ember is priced between the two others: Model Prompt size Input ($/M) Cached input Output GPT-6 Luna ?272k $0.10 $0.01 $0.50 >272k $0.20 $0.02 $0.75 Muse Ember 1.0 ?200k $0.10 $0.004 $0.50 >200k $0.30 $0.012 $1.50 Claude Haiku 5.5 ?100k $0.10 $0.01 $0.50 >100k $0.50 $0.05 $2.50 But comparing price-per-token doesn’t really make sense these days, when reasoning tokens me...

2. Quoting Prompting Claude Fable 5.2
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-11-10T05:34:14+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Nov/10/prompting-claude-fable-52/
Claude Fable 5.2 responds closely to what the prompt says about who owns the code it works on. In Anthropic?s testing on small coding tasks, when a prompt said nothing about ownership or presented the code base as someone else?s, the model tended to add to the existing structure, even when that repeated existing code. [...] If you want the model to improve the structure as it works, say that the code is its own: This codebase is yours: what it’s for and how it’s built are your call, and you’ll keep building on it. In Anthropic?s testing on small coding tasks, the model merged repeated code in about half of the tries with this sentence, and in under a tenth of the tries without it. ? Prompting Claude Fable 5.2 , Anthropic documentation
Tags: prompt-engineering , anthropic , generative-ai , ai , llms , claude-mythos-fable

3. Yonkers Rises
Source: Simon Willison’s Weblog | Published: 2026-11-10T03:53:04+00:00
Link: https://simonwillison.net/2026/Nov/10/yonkers-rises/
Tool: Yonkers Rises I realized I didn’t know where Yonkers was, so I looked it up on Google Maps and then, to help embed its location and shape in my head (and to try out Claude Fable 5.2’s 3D modeling and animation skills), I prompted Fable 5.2 Medium to: Make a three js animation where yonkers stands up as a big mech (cool stand up motion) and Ætomos around manhattan and queens and Brooklyn, use openstreetmap mapping data It correctly deduced that "Ætomos" was a mobile keyboard typo for "stomps": Tags: three-js , llms , ai , generative-ai , claude-mythos-fable

4. [Sponsor] WorkOS: Let Agents Use Your Tools Without Giving Them Free Rein
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-11-10T04:14:31Z
Link: https://www.workos.com/airlock?utm_source=daringfireball&utm_medium=newsletter&utm_campaign=q42026
An agent?s job isn?t known until it runs, so a role assigned in advance is always too much or too little. Give the agent a task instead, and every call it makes gets checked against that intent, whether it?s reading a Linear issue or emailing a distribution list. With WorkOS Airlock, you set the policies once. Each call is allowed, denied, or sent to a human for approval, and every verdict is logged. Request early access ? ?

5. Bloomberg Was Onto Megaspeed?s Game a Year Ago

Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-11-09T23:46:17Z
Link: https://www.bloomberg.com/news/features/2025-12-22/nvidia-partner-megaspeed-draws-china-chip-smuggling-concerns-in-us
Mackenzie Hawkins, Andy Lin, and Kari Soo Lindberg, reporting for Bloomberg last year on December 22 (Archive.today link): In an industry run by titans, a Singapore AI firm called Megaspeed International Pte. is drawing an unusual amount of attention. In less than three years, the once-obscure spinoff of a Chinese gaming enterprise has evolved into the single largest Southeast Asian buyer of Nvidia Corp. chips ? a rapid ascent that?s lifted hopes for a regional champion in the lucrative business of AI cloud computing. Now Megaspeed finds itself a focal point of Washington?s long-held fears about semiconductor smuggling into China, an issue of escalating concern among national security hawks despite Nvidia?s repeated assurances that chip diversion doesn?t exist. [...] Nvidia, which conducts regular spot-checks of data centers around the world, told Bloomberg that it went to Megaspeed?s facilities multiple times to verify that there?s nothing untoward. ?Our visits confirmed that the GPUs shipped to Megaspeed by our partners are where they are supposed to be,? an Nvidia spokesperson said in mid-November. It turns out these inspections were rather intimately thorough, conducted firs...

6. Short-Seller Culper Research Published Information on Jensen Huang?s Affair Back in May
Source: Daring Fireball | Published: 2026-11-09T20:57:04Z
Link: https://culperresearch.com/wp-content/uploads/2026/05/Culper_NVDA_5-13-2026.pdf
Culper Research is a short-seller that published a report (PDF and in a thread on X) in May alleging that Nvidia ?had a China problem?. From the start of its report: Nvidia claims that its business in China went to ?zero? after April 2025 U.S. trade restrictions. We believe that in reality, over 20% of Nvidia?s FY 2026 compute revenues remained driven by China ? supported both by illegal GPU diversion and Southeast Asian intermediaries. Nvidia has repeatedly vouched for Megaspeed ? its single largest Southeast Asian chip buyer currently under investigation by both U.S. Commerce and Singapore authorities ? as ?wholly owned and operated by a company based and headquartered outside China, with no China shareholders.? Nvidia has also claimed that it has ?repeatedly tested and sampled data centers around the world and found no diversion.? Documents we uncovered, however, suggest that Megaspeed has been secretly financed by Alibaba via a series of apparent shell companies. Tellingly, Nvidia?s lawyered phrasing ? that Megaspeed holds no Chinese equity ? doesn?t seem to preclude Chinese financing . From Culper?s report on X (replete with another photo of Huang and Huang alongside each o...

7. If the Windows Update hot patcher checks that the function hasn?t already been patched, does that mean you can?t install two hot-patches?
Source: The Old New Thing | Published: Mon, 09 Nov 2026 15:00:00 +0000
Link: https://devblogs.microsoft.com/oldnewthing/20261109-00/?p=112841/
It knows what it did. The post If the Windows Update hot patcher checks that the function hasn?t already been patched, does that mean you can?t install two hot-patches? appeared first on The Old New Thing .

8. AI and Irontown
Source: Armin Ronacher’s Thoughts and Writings | Published: 2026-11-09T00:00:00+00:00
Link: https://lucumr.pocoo.org/2026/11/9/irontown/
For our last movie night we watched Princess Mononoke . I remembered loving that movie when I was younger, but watching it as an adult made me once again realize how Miyazaki has a way of expressing diverging sides without picking one. The film shows people, animals and spirits with legitimate and largely incompatible needs, and each faction is further engaged in infighting. A central arc of the story is Lady Eboshi?s Irontown, which gives people who were largely rejected by society work, protection and dignity. She gives shelter and work to those who have leprosy and to former sex workers. The mine and the weapon factory provide them with a livelihood, but they also destroy the forest around them. The forest?s inhabitants, in particular the boars, response choose war against the humans to defend themselves. Eboshi is not portrayed as a villain. She does real good for the people of Irontown, but also is an arms

manufacturer who is destroying the forest around it. The film anchors around a character called Ashitaka, who has been condemned to death by an unfortunate encounter with a god that was turned into a demon after being fatally wounded by one of Eboshi?s guns. He doesn?t take...

9. Combinatorial designs
Source: John D. Cook | Published: Tue, 10 Nov 2026 01:38:48 +0000
Link: https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/11/09/combinatorial-designs/
The last several posts have been building up to this one, moving from tangible to more abstract. The posts on finite geometry gave examples of Steiner triples and more generally Steiner systems, introduced in the previous post. Combinatorial designs take this one step further. The previous post gave the following definition: A Steiner triple system, [?] The post Combinatorial designs first appeared on John D. Cook .

10. Steiner Systems
Source: John D. Cook | Published: Mon, 09 Nov 2026 17:01:43 +0000
Link: https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/11/09/steiner-systems/
Steiner triples Several examples from the recent posts on finite geometry are special cases of Steiner triples. A Steiner triple system, written STS(n), is a collection of three-element subsets, called blocks, of a set X with n elements, such that every two-element subset of X belongs to exactly one block. STS(7) is the smallest finite projective [?] The post Steiner Systems first appeared on John D. Cook .

11. Finite hyperbolic planes
Source: John D. Cook | Published: Mon, 09 Nov 2026 14:26:09 +0000
Link: https://www.johndcook.com/blog/2026/11/09/finite-hyperbolic-planes/
Euclid?s fifth postulate says that given a line ? and a point P not on ? , there is a unique line through P parallel to ?. In the projective plane there are no parallel lines, and in the hyperbolic plane there are at least two lines through P parallel to ?. Recent posts have looked at finite [?] The post Finite hyperbolic planes first appeared on John D. Cook .

12. Pluralistic: America cannot undo Trumpism (09 Nov 2026)
Source: Pluralistic: Daily links from Cory Doctorow | Published: Mon, 09 Nov 2026 08:12:24 +0000
Link: https://pluralistic.net/2026/11/09/brunch-is-canceled-forever/
Today’s links America cannot undo Trumpism: The only way out is through. Hey look at this: Delights to delectate. Object permanence: Bruces x Pokemon; Rich countries and WIPO conspire to kill developement agenda; Wired photos go CC; "Mortality Bridge"; Drones over Disney; CBC v podcast apps; Realtor x election eschatology; Right-clicker mentality; "Victories Greater Than Death"; Facebook’s fraud files; Zune v Universal; Ben and Jerry’s x OWS; Nudging is bunk; History of Chinese sf; How Audi cheated; Trump runs the surveillance state; Stockholm v interop. Upcoming appearances: Courtenay, Vancouver, Folkestone, Oxford, Sheffield, Virtual, Oxford, Santa Barbara, Montreal. Recent appearances: Where I’ve been. Latest books: You keep readin’ em, I’ll keep writin’ ’em. Upcoming books: Like I said, I’ll keep writin’ ’em.
Colophon: All the rest. America cannot undo Trumpism (permalink) True Carneyism has never been tried. When Canadian PM Mark Carney traveled to Davos to declare a "rupture" in the old order (and admit that this old order was never that great to begin with) he told us that there was no going back from Trumpism. The only way out of Trumpism was through: https://www.weforum.o...

13. Optimal virulence and the Android lockdown
Source: DYNOMIGHT | Published: 2026-11-09T00:00:00+00:00
Link: https://dynomight.net/android/
When you get a cold, the virus hijacks your cells and uses them to make copies of itself, destroying the cells in the process. The virus does not care about you. And yet, if you get a cold, your body doesn?t dissolve into a pile of virus-enriched goo as a result of all your cells disregarding survival to focus on virus manufacturing. Why? Well, you have an immune

system. But also, if that did happen, other people would say, ?Oh no, Alice has dissolved into a pile of virus-enriched goo; we should stay away lest we also become goo piles.? Better to just hijack some of your cells, so you can walk around and spread the virus to other people. Thus, the theory of optimal virulence says that a more laid-back cold virus will be more successful in the long run, which is why the cold viruses that thrive today are the non-goo-pile-converting kind. Anyway. Most people reading this have paid Apple $400-$1600 for a phone on which you can?t do anything without Apple?s permission and monitoring. That was a strange decision, but on Android phones you can run whatever you want. For example, I noticed a couple of months ago that all RSS apps were terrible, so I spent 15 long minutes having AI make m...

14. Introducing Ninety
Source: Andrew Nesbitt | Published: 2026-11-09T12:00:00+00:00
Link: https://nesbitt.io/2026/11/09/introducing-ninety.html
We?re excited to announce Ninety, the first prediction market for open source security, launching today in partnership with Lanternfish, the frontier AI lab for software security. Security report volumes at major projects are four to five times higher than in 2024 . Attackers and defenders are both running frontier models against the same few thousand packages, and everything those models turn up is scattered across disclosure inboxes, private chats, embargo lists and exploit brokers, with no price attached. Ninety puts a price on it. Anyone can take a position on whether an open source project will have a vulnerability disclosed, how severe it will be, and how long the fix will take. Researchers earn from the markets they called correctly, and defenders who harden code earn when contracts resolve NO. Everyone who depends on open source gets a per-project price for how secure their dependencies are, updated every second. Rationale Bug bounties make one payment to whoever finds a bug, after the report is in. Grant programs fund a handful of projects a year after a long application process. Both fall behind when a single model run can produce forty plausible reports before lunch, an...

15. Blunt Banhammer Blocks Basic Bots Ballistically
Source: Terence Eden?s Blog | Published: Mon, 09 Nov 2026 12:34:00 +0000
Link: https://shkspr.mobi/blog/2026/11/blunt-banhammer-blocks-basic-bots-ballistically/
I cut bot traffic to my site by over 80% with a simple trap. Last month, my hobby website OpenBenches.org transferred more than 2.5TB of data to visitors. As much as I’d like to think the site is enormously popular, it looks like it is just AI bots endlessly crawling the data and slurping up the images. So I’ve built B to be an indiscriminate tool to eradicate these unwanted parasites. It is?

16. The classic console corner’s CRT changeover
Source: Old Vintage Computing Research | Published: 2026-11-09T22:23:17.979-08:00
Link: https://oldvcr.blogspot.com/2026/11/the-classic-console-corners-crt.html
In the corner of the rear Floodgap lab sits a pile of classic game consoles. It used to look like this: The centrepiece is the 20" Panasonic cathode ray tube TV-VCR on the cart (and a DVD player balanced on top), because with the exception of the Sega Dreamcast all the consoles here only came with NTSC RF output and date from the pre-flat panel TV era. That includes multiple Atari consoles (including the inevitable VCS, here a Darth Vader 2600), several Pong machines ? including two Commodore units ? with various chipsets, an Intellivision (as the rebadged Tandyvision One , my first) and a Bally Astrocade with lots of upgrades. It seems wrong to use them with a flat panel, and CRTs lag less. Plus, games with a light gun (here the Dreamcast and one of the Pong consoles) often rely on the CRT’s rapidly scanning beam to know where they’re pointed. So what do you do when the CRT TV goes bad? You track down another one, and then labouriously redo all the connections so you can still play the games. Yes, this article is basically just a big bubbling ball of nostalgia. My consoles ? let me show you them. I should note that this isn’t all the old school gaming fun in the house. In the com...

17. Weekly Update 529: Kids Social Media Bans (and Everything Else)
Source: Troy Hunt | Published: Tue, 10 Nov 2026 00:42:35 GMT
Link: https://www.troyhunt.com/weekly-update-529/
The kids-and-social-media discussion is just dumb. It’s not the premise of delaying their access until 16, but the inability of those who should know better to grasp where the responsibility for enforcement lies. Here’s our PM’s explainer after the laws passed